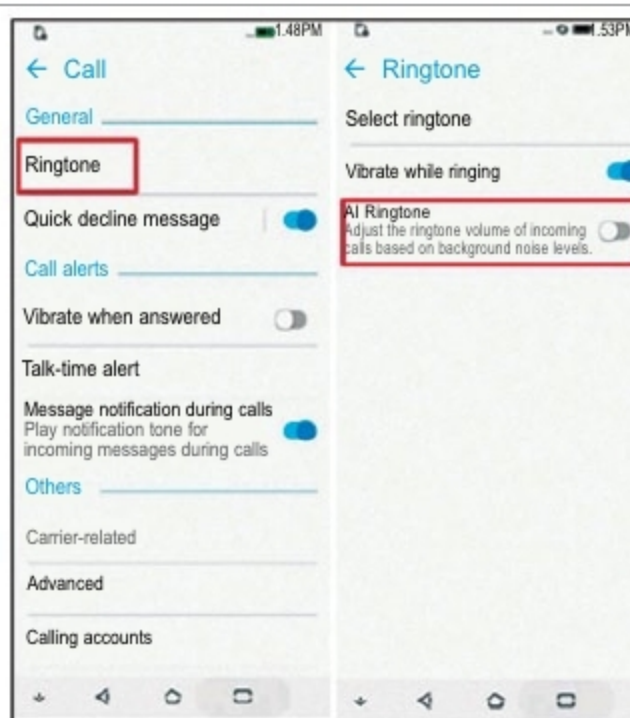




Smart refrigerator by Samsung that cannot handle itself



Smartphone by Asus with AI ringtone

Artificial intelligence-based applications

munity would tend to disavow them, but be known that these have already made their way to the crowd anyway.

The figure above shows only a couple of examples, which are merely the tip of an iceberg of AI junk out there. Things like AI ringtones and other similar (so-called smart) things really need to stop polluting the real technology market.

Why we need to challenge this kind of stuff

Well, first, I am not against emerging technologies at all; rather, I am a strong proponent. However, what I do not quite appreciate is quantity over quality. I think it often promotes false economics, and here is why.

- Simply pushing for more quantity (of tech solutions) without paying attention to quality (of solutions) adds a lot of garbage out in the field.
- This garbage, when out there in the market, creates disillusionment and, in turn, adds to the resistance in healthy adoption.
- This approach (quantity versus quality) also encourages bad practices by creators of AI at customers' expense, where sub-par solutions are pushed down their throat by leveraging their ignorance and an urge to give in to FOMO (fear of missing out).

Stuff like this happens during the hype cycle for any new and upcoming trend or technology. If this is happening with AI, there is nothing new, *per se*.

The problem though is that flaws

in sub-par technologies do not surface until it is too late. In many cases, the damage is already done and is irreversible. Unlike many other technologies, where things simply work or do not work, there is a significant grey area that can change its shades over time. Moreover, if we are not clear in which direction that would be, we end up creating junk.

We not only need to challenge the quality of every solution but also improvise our approach towards emerging technologies in general.

How we can encourage a better approach

There is no golden rule or checklist as such for a better approach. Nonetheless, a few things I can suggest are:

Seeking transparency in solution. You would notice that people who make something often replicate their inner self in the output. A casual approach or thinking would encourage a casual output, and so would the meticulous thinking result in better output. Programmers who have clarity of mind and cleanliness in behaviour often create a clean and flawless program.

We must make people responsible and accountable for their output. In case of AI, if it does a bad job, ask creators to explain and seek transparency. Hiding behind deep learning algorithms and saying, "AI did it!" will not cut it.

People will often tell you that knowing inner mechanics is not important

for users, only the output is. We must challenge this argument. For many other technologies, such as a car or microwave oven, this argument might hold true, but for AI, it does not!

For each action automation or AI takes, creators should be able to explain why their technology did that.

Seeking quality and accountability of outcomes. People may (most likely) rely on technology and automation for their business-critical or life-critical functions. Bringing in

people who would take accountability of outcomes seriously is often a better decision. Unless the application is for fancy or sheer playfulness, we need to put a responsible adult in charge.

Machine learning is essentially teaching a computer to label things with examples rather than with programmed instructions. In addition, AI that is based on this learning can do wrong things only in two circumstances. First, if the fundamental logic of decision making programmed in it (by humans) is flawed, that is, bad programming; or the dataset it was trained on is incorrectly labelled (by humans), that is, of bad data quality. In either case, the machine will do the wrong thing or do it wrong!

Here, creators cannot just wash their hands off and say, they do not know what went wrong when something goes awry. Humans need to take responsibility on embedding those wrong fundamentals and take accountability of outcomes.

The world, even today, looks at parents if their child does something wrong, questioning their upbringing methods and practices. Then why cannot we look at the creators of AI solutions the same way?

We should start assigning liability to creators of AI, much as we do now with guns, and make quality acceptance parameters stricter.

Being careful with MVP people. No doubt that a minimum viable product, aka MVP, is key to developing a